PROBITY: CONCEPT AND PHILOSOPHICAL BASIS OF GOVERNANCE

ENTRUSTED OFFICE AND LEGITIMACY → NON-HIERARCHICAL OVERLAP MAP → LAW, PROPRIETY AND REMEDY → CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE → HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK → DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 ENTRUSTED OFFICE AND LEGITIMACY

STAGE 00 · ENTRUSTED OFFICE AND LEGITIMACY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 1. ENTRUSTED OFFICE AND LEGITIMACY · [1] CITIZENS CONFER AUTHORITY · [2] LAW DEFINES COMPETENCE · [3] OFFICE HOLDS DISCRETION · [4] PUBLIC PURPOSE LIMITS USE · [5] REASONS EXPLAIN CHOICE

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. Entrusted office and legitimacy
- [1] Citizens confer authority
- [2] Law defines competence

MECHANISM

- [3] Office holds discretion
- [4] Public purpose limits use
- [5] Reasons explain choice
- [6] Records permit scrutiny

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Review corrects error
- [8] Legitimacy earns trust
- VERDICT → Public power becomes legitimate when entrusted authority remains purpose-bound and reviewable.
- ANSWER USE → Use to define probity and open governance answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Public power becomes legitimate when entrusted authority remains purpose-bound and reviewable.

01 NON-HIERARCHICAL OVERLAP MAP

STAGE 01 · NON-HIERARCHICAL OVERLAP MAP · CENTRAL FOCUS · 2. NON-HIERARCHICAL OVERLAP MAP · [1] HONESTY, TRUTHFUL DISCLOSURE · [2] INTEGRITY · PRINCIPLE UNDER PRESSURE · [3] PROPRIETY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[4] Transparency: visible record	VERDICT → Compare functional questions; never reduce honesty to a settled subset.
2. Non-hierarchical overlap map	[5] Accountability: answer and correct	ANSWER USE → Use for definitions, distinctions and close-option traps.
[1] Honesty: truthful disclosure	[6] Probity: public-office test	MUST REMEMBER: Probity is integrity and propriety in the exercise of public power, not...
[2] Integrity: principle under pressure	[7] Concepts overlap	

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. Non-hierarchical overlap map
- [1] Honesty: truthful disclosure
- [2] Integrity: principle under pressure
- [3] Propriety: fitness for office

MECHANISM

- [4] Transparency: visible record
- [5] Accountability: answer and correct
- [6] Probity: public-office test
- [7] Concepts overlap
- [8] No rigid nesting

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Compare functional questions; never reduce honesty to a settled subset.
- ANSWER USE → Use for definitions, distinctions and close-option traps.
- MUST REMEMBER: Probity is integrity and propriety in the exercise of public power, not...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Compare functional questions; never reduce honesty to a settled subset.

02 LAW, PROPRIETY AND REMEDY

STAGE 02 · LAW, PROPRIETY AND REMEDY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 3. LAW, PROPRIETY AND REMEDY · [1] IDENTIFY LEGAL AUTHORITY · [2] CHECK MANDATORY PROCEDURE · [3] TEST EQUALITY AND FAIRNESS · [4] ASK OFFICE APPROPRIATENESS · [5] ASK AUTHORISED PURPOSE

CENTRAL FOCUS

3. Law, propriety and remedy → [1] Identify legal authority → [2] Check mandatory procedure

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Law, propriety and remedy
- [1] Identify legal authority
- [2] Check mandatory procedure
- [3] Test equality and fairness

MECHANISM

- [4] Ask office appropriateness
- [5] Ask authorised purpose
- [6] Record proportional reasons
- [7] Provide competent review
- [8] Secure correction or remedy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Legality is the floor; propriety, purpose and remedy complete the probity inquiry.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Dr. X and form-versus-substance cases.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Procedural probity asks whether authority, process, reasons and...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Legality is the floor; propriety, purpose and remedy complete the probity inquiry.

03 CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE

STAGE 03 · CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 4. CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE · [1] IDENTIFY PRIVATE INTEREST · [2] ASSESS MATERIAL CONNECTION · [3] DISCLOSE BEFORE DECISION · [4] STOP INFORMAL CONTACT · [5] RECUSE WHEN IMPARTIALITY RISKS

CENTRAL FOCUS

4. Conflict and recusal route → [1] Identify private interest → [2] Assess material connection

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Conflict and recusal route
- [1] Identify private interest
- [2] Assess material connection
- [3] Disclose before decision

MECHANISM

- [4] Stop informal contact
- [5] Recuse when impartiality risks
- [6] Reassign independently
- [7] Preserve decision record
- [8] Review appearance and outcome

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Private confidence in fairness cannot replace institutional conflict control.
- ANSWER USE → Use for procurement, licensing and appointment cases.
- EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: Specify risk-graded controls across conflict...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Private confidence in fairness cannot replace institutional conflict control.

04 HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK

STAGE 04 · HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK · CENTRAL FOCUS · 5. HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK · [1] GRADE VALUE AND HARM · [2] PUBLISH OBJECTIVE CRITERIA · [3] GIVE EQUAL INFORMATION · [4] SEPARATE DECISION ROLES · [5] RECORD CONFLICTS AND RECUSALS

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. High-discretion control stack
- [1] Grade value and harm
- [2] Publish objective criteria

MECHANISM

- [3] Give equal information
- [4] Separate decision roles
- [5] Record conflicts and recusals
- [6] Require written reasons

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Use focused audit
- [8] Keep appeal and remedy
- VERDICT → Controls should intensify with discretion, value and foreseeable harm.
- ANSWER USE → Use for land, licensing and specialised procurement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Controls should intensify with discretion, value and foreseeable harm.

05 DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY

STAGE 05 · DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 6. DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY · [1] DUTY BINDS DESPITE DETECTION · [2] PERSONS ARE NOT MERE MEANS · [3] OFFICE LIMITS PRIVATE GAIN · [4] CONSTITUTION SUPPLIES VALUES · [5] EQUALITY DISCIPLINES CHOICE

CENTRAL FOCUS → 6. Deontology and constitutional morality → [1] Duty binds despite detection → [2] Persons are not mere means → [3] Office limits private gain

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Deontology and constitutional morality
- [1] Duty binds despite detection
- [2] Persons are not mere means

MECHANISM

- [3] Office limits private gain
- [4] Constitution supplies values
- [5] Equality disciplines choice
- [6] Due process disciplines means

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Review restrains power
- [8] Public reason joins both
- VERDICT → Duty sets moral limits; constitutional morality gives them public institutional form.
- ANSWER USE → Use for philosophical-basis and 2019/2025 PYQs.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Duty sets moral limits; constitutional morality gives them public institutional form.

06 VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS

STAGE 06 · VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS · CENTRAL FOCUS · 7. VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS · [1] PRACTICE TRUTHFUL CONDUCT · [2] BUILD STABLE INTEGRITY · [3] CULTIVATE COURAGE · [4] CULTIVATE JUSTICE · [5] READ CONTEXT CAREFULLY

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Virtue and phronesis → [1] Practice truthful conduct → [2] Build stable integrity

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Virtue and phronesis
- [1] Practice truthful conduct
- [2] Build stable integrity

MECHANISM

- [3] Cultivate courage
- [4] Cultivate justice
- [5] Read context carefully
- [6] Balance relevant duties

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Choose proportionate means
- [8] Accept public verification
- VERDICT → Practical wisdom applies stable virtue without abandoning reasons or institutions.
- ANSWER USE → Use when rules leave lawful discretion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Practical wisdom applies stable virtue without abandoning reasons or institutions.

07 TRUSTEESHIP BOUNDARY

STAGE 07 · TRUSTEESHIP BOUNDARY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 8. TRUSTEESHIP BOUNDARY · [1] AUTHORITY COMES FROM CITIZENS · [2] OFFICE IS NOT PROPERTY · [3] GANDHI · POWER AS STEWARDSHIP · [4] MEANS MUST FIT ENDS

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Trusteeship boundary → [1] Authority comes from citizens → [2] Office is not property

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Trusteeship boundary
- [1] Authority comes from citizens
- [2] Office is not property

MECHANISM

- [3] Gandhi: power as stewardship
- [4] Means must fit ends
- [5] Public-office trust is analogy
- [6] Natural-resource doctrine is settled

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] M.C. Mehta boundary retained
- [8] Specific law still controls
- VERDICT → Use trusteeship philosophically, not as a universal environmental-doctrine holding.
- ANSWER USE → Use to gain sophistication without legal overclaiming.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Use trusteeship philosophically, not as a universal environmental-doctrine holding.

08 PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY PACT

STAGE 08 · PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY PACT · CENTRAL FOCUS · 9. PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY PACT · [1] INCORPORATE PACT IN BID · [2] BUYER REJECTS CORRUPT INFLUENCE · [3] SELLERS REJECT BRIBERY · [4] SELLERS REJECT COLLUSION · [5] PROTECT ELECTRONIC INFORMATION

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. Procurement Integrity Pact
- [1] Incorporate pact in bid
- [2] Buyer rejects corrupt influence

MECHANISM

- [3] Sellers reject bribery
- [4] Sellers reject collusion
- [5] Protect electronic information
- [6] Treat bidders equitably

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Report vigilance concerns
- [8] Retain other safeguards
- VERDICT → The Pact is an incorporated preventive control, not proof of guilt or a complete regime.
- ANSWER USE → Use with GeM bid document 9511605.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The Pact is an incorporated preventive control, not proof of guilt or a complete regime.

09 ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS

STAGE 09 · ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS · CENTRAL FOCUS · 10. ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS · [1] RPA S75A · ELECTED MP · [2] FILE WITHIN 90 DAYS OF OATH · [3] NOT AN ANNUAL RPA RETURN · [4] CCS RULE 18

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] Not an annual RPA return	[7] Lokpal s44 text substituted
10. Asset-disclosure distinctions	[4] CCS Rule 18: service regime	[8] No universal online claim
[1] RPA s75A: elected MP	[5] AIS Rule 16: separate regime	VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.
[2] File within 90 days of oath	[6] Annual property returns differ	ANSWER USE → Use for Prelims traps and probity mechanisms.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Asset-disclosure distinctions
- [1] RPA s75A: elected MP
- [2] File within 90 days of oath

MECHANISM

- [3] Not an annual RPA return
- [4] CCS Rule 18: service regime
- [5] AIS Rule 16: separate regime
- [6] Annual property returns differ

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Lokpal s44 text substituted
- [8] No universal online claim
- VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Prelims traps and probity mechanisms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.

10 RTI, AUDIT AND SOCIAL AUDIT

STAGE 10 · RTI, AUDIT AND SOCIAL AUDIT · CENTRAL FOCUS · 11. RTI, AUDIT AND SOCIAL AUDIT · [1] RECORDS MAKE ACTION VISIBLE · [2] RTI ENABLES LAWFUL ACCESS · [3] DEPARTMENTAL AUDIT CHECKS SYSTEMS · [4] CAG ACTS WITHIN MANDATE · [5] CVC OVERSEES VIGILANCE

CENTRAL FOCUS → 11. RTI, audit and social audit → [1] Records make action visible → [2] RTI enables lawful access → [3] Departmental audit checks systems

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. RTI, audit and social audit
- [1] Records make action visible
- [2] RTI enables lawful access

MECHANISM

- [3] Departmental audit checks systems
- [4] CAG acts within mandate
- [5] CVC oversees vigilance
- [6] CVO coordinates departments

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Citizens verify lived delivery
- [8] Follow-up supplies accountability
- VERDICT → No single institution replaces financial, vigilance, citizen and remedial scrutiny.
- ANSWER USE → Use for 2021 social-audit and transparency answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → No single institution replaces financial, vigilance, citizen and remedial scrutiny.

11 BONA FIDES AND PROPORTIONATE REVIEW

STAGE 11 · BONA FIDES AND PROPORTIONATE REVIEW · CENTRAL FOCUS · 12. BONA FIDES AND PROPORTIONATE REVIEW · [1] VERIFY AUTHORITY AND FACTS · [2] DISCLOSE MATERIAL INTERESTS · [3] CONSIDER REASONABLE ALTERNATIVES · [4] RECORD CONTEMPORANEOUS REASONS · [5] PROTECT HONEST RISK-TAKING

CENTRAL FOCUS → 12. Bona fides and proportionate review → [1] Verify authority and facts → [2] Disclose material interests → [3] Consider reasonable alternatives

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. Bona fides and proportionate review
- [1] Verify authority and facts
- [2] Disclose material interests

MECHANISM

- [3] Consider reasonable alternatives
- [4] Record contemporaneous reasons
- [5] Protect honest risk-taking
- [6] Review without outcome bias

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Correct proven error
- [8] Remedy supported harm
- VERDICT → Good-faith protection blocks hindsight punishment, not evidence, review or remedy.
- ANSWER USE → Use as the final advanced answer and case-study test.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Good-faith protection blocks hindsight punishment, not evidence, review or remedy.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. ARCHITECTURE · 2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS · 3. DETAILED TREATMENT · 4. INSTITUTIONAL AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE · 5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES · 6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS · 7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- 1. Architecture
- 2. Concepts and distinctions
- 3. Detailed treatment
- 4. Institutional and reform architecture

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 5. Indian applications and boundary cases
- 6. Limitations and trade-offs
- 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims
- 8. Advanced Prelims traps

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 9. Current application
- 10. PYQ-based analytical application
- 11. Mains-ready framework
- 12. Probable questions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels